

IDIOMS & PHRASES

To drive home = to emphasise

Kick the bucket = died

To cut corners = to do something badly or cheaply to save money or time

To show the white feather = to show signs to cowardice

Black sheep = a disreputable member of a family or a group

With flying colours = very successfully

On cloud nine = extremely happy or elated

Raining cats and dogs = it's raining heavily

Head over heels = excited

To pick holes = to criticize someone

Hit the nail on the head = said exactly the right thing

A big bug = a person of importance

Pros and cons = favourable and unfavourable factors

Swan song = the last public performance of an artist or athlete

Hear it on the grapevine = spread rumours

Get the axe = to be fired / lose the job

Read between lines = to understand the hidden meaning of the writer

To die in harness = to expire while working, prior to retirement

Sell for a song = at a very low price

Tooth and nail = with all the power

In cold blood = cruelly

Maiden speech = one's first speech

Once in a blue moon = very rarely

A stone's throw = at a very short distance

At your beck and call = under someone's absolute control

A bolt from the blue = sudden and totally unexpected

At an arm's length = to keep away at a distance

A wild goose chase = foolish or hopeless search

At sixes and sevens = in a state of confusion / in complete disorder

A hot potato = a controversial issue

Couch potato = a lazy person who usually spends time on watching television

Apple pie order = perfect order or neatness

A stone's throw = a short distance

At the eleventh hour = at the last possible moment

A cock and bull story = an imaginary story used as an excuse

A fish out of water = to be in an uncomfortable position

A flash in the pan = something that has a strong start but quickly fails

Crocodile tears = tears that are insincere

An axe to grind = selfish motive

A hard nut to crack = a difficult problem to solve

A baker's dozen = thirteen

Beat about the bush = discuss a matter without coming to the point

Burn the candle at the both ends = to work hard without rest

Chicken - hearted = easily frightened

Dog in the manger = a person who selfishly keeps something that he or she does not really need so that others may not use or enjoy it.

Dog's life = miserable life

In cold blood = cruelly

Hot under the collar = angry

In a nutshell = in the fewest words possible

Kick the bucket = die

Lion's share = major part

Red handed = to be caught doing something wrong

Red letter day = A special or memorable day

Rain cats and dogs = rain very heavily

Swan song = a person's last performance

To build castles in the air = to form imaginary plans

To make both ends meet = to earn just to survive

Thick and thin = under all conditions

In black and white = a written document

The alpha and omega = beginning and end

White elephant = expensive but useless possession

To blow one's own trumpet = to boast

A Herculean task = a very difficult work

To save one's skin = to protect oneself

A snake in the grass = a hidden enemy

A stepping stone = a source of advancement

All and sundry = everyone without distinction

To set one's teeth on edge = irritate

To let the grass grow under one's feet = to remain idle

Wolf in sheep's clothing = hypocrite

Flying off the handle = lose one's temper suddenly and unexpectedly / suddenly become very angry)

At loggerheads = in violent dispute or disagreement.

Red in the face = embarrassed or ashamed

Blue in the face = to be exhausted or frustrated usually from talking or arguing about something for a long time.

On the trot = consecutively

Blood ran cold = suddenly frightened / horrified

Round the corner = very near

To take the reins = to assume command

Shall we call it a day ? = shall we stop working ?

Let the cat out of the bag = reveal a secret carelessly or by mistake

bury the hatchet = Stop enmity / end a conflict or quarrel

break a leg' means:= Good luck.

Wool gathering = Daydreaming.

1. The idiom 'to drive home' means:
- a) To emphasize.
 - b) Foolish or hopeless search
 - c) Perfect
 - d) A short distance

- a) To emphasize = to drive home
- b) Foolish or hopeless search = a wild goose search
- c) Perfect = apple pie order
- d) A short distance = a stone's throw

2. Identify the meaning of the idiom from the given sentence.

He kicked the bucket.

- a) Cruelly
- b) Died.
- c) Angry
- d) None of these

- a) Cruelly = in cold blood
- b) Died = kick the bucket
- c) Angry = hot under the collar

BIJEEESH10

3. 'To cut corners' means:

- a) To do something badly or cheaply to save money or time.
- b) A difficult problem to solve
- c) Selfish motive
- d) None of these

- a) To do something badly or cheaply to save money or time = to cut corners
- b) A difficult problem to solve = a hard nut to crack
- c) Selfish motive = an axe to grind

4. 'To show the white feather' means:

- a) Easily frightened
- b) To show sign of cowardice.
- c) A miserable life
- d) None of these

- a) Easily frightened = chicken - hearted
- b) To show sign of cowardice = to show the white feather
- c) A miserable life = dog's life

5. What is 'a black sheep'?

- a) A disreputable member of a family or a group.
- b) Under someone's absolute control
- c) Sudden and totally unexpected
- d) None of these

- a) A disreputable member of a family or a group = a black sheep
- b) Under someone's absolute control = at your beck and call
- c) Sudden and totally unexpected = a bolt from the blue

6. Complete the following sentence using the appropriate idiom.

Balu passed the exam

- a) With flying colours.
- b) On the spot
- c) To form imaginary plans
- d) None of these

- a) With flying colours = very successfully
- b) On the spot = red handed
- c) To form imaginary plans = to build castles in the air

7. A big bug means:

- a) Person of importance.
- b) A person's last performance
- c) To form imaginary plans
- d) None of these

- a) Person of importance = a big bug
- b) A person's last performance = swan song
- c) To form imaginary plans = to build castles in the air

8. The idiom 'pros and cons' means:

- a) To earn just to survive
- b) To rain very heavily
- c) A sad day
- d) Favourable and unfavourable factors.

- a) To earn just to survive = to make both ends meet
- b) To rain very heavily = rain cats and dogs
- c) A sad day = red letter day
- d) Favourable and unfavourable factors = pros and cons

9. The idiom swan song means:

- a) The last public performance of an artist or an athlete.
- b) Very rarely
- c) Major part
- d) To die

- a) The last public performance of an artist or an athlete = swan song
- b) Very rarely = once in a blue moon
- c) Major part = lion's share
- d) To die = kick the bucket

10. Meaning of the idiom 'hear it on the grape vine' means:

- a) Spread rumours.
- b) Cruelly
- c) Angry
- d) A controversial or sensitive issue

- a) Spread rumours = hear it on the grape vine
- b) Cruelly = in cold blood
- c) Angry = hot under the collar
- d) A controversial or sensitive issue = hot potato

11. What does the underlined idiom mean:

So many employees got the axe as the company was undergoing financial crisis.

- a) Lost the job.
- b) To be afraid
- c) Under all conditions
- d) None of these

- a) Lost the job = got the axe
- b) To be afraid = to get cold feet
- c) Under all conditions = thick and thin

12. 'In cold blood' means:

- a) Cruelly.
- b) Angry
- c) Easily frightened
- d) None of these

- a) Cruelly = in cold blood
- b) Angry = hot under the collar
- c) Easily frightened = chicken - hearted

13. A baker's dozen means:

- a) Thirteen.
- b) Major part
- c) Very rarely
- d) Very happy

- a) Thirteen = a baker's dozen
- b) Major part = lion's share
- c) Very rarely = once in a blue moon
- d) Very happy = in high spirits

14. The idiom 'a stone's throw' means:

- a) At a very short distance.
- b) Selfish motive
- c) A difficult problem to solve
- d) None of these

- a) At a very short distance = a stone's throw
- b) Selfish motive = an axe to grind
- c) A difficult problem to solve = a hard nut to crack

15. 'Crocodile tears' means:

- a) Tears that are insincere.
- b) To be afraid
- c) Expensive but useless possession
- d) Under all conditions

- a) Tears that are insincere = tears that are insincere
- b) To be afraid = to get cold feet
- c) Expensive but useless possession = white elephant
- d) Under all conditions = thick and thin

16. 'Couch potato' means:

- a) A lazy person who usually spends time on watching television.
- b) To earn just to survive
- c) To form imaginary plans
- d) Suspect that something is wrong

- a) A lazy person who usually spends time on watching television = couch potato
- b) To earn just to survive = to make both ends meet
- c) To form imaginary plans = to build castles in the air
- d) Suspect that something is wrong = smell a rat

17. 'A flash in the pan' means:

- a) Very happy
- b) A controversial or sensitive issue
- c) Easily frightened
- d) Something that has a strong start but quickly fails.

- a) Very happy = in high spirits
- b) A controversial or sensitive issue = hot potato
- c) Easily frightened = chicken - hearted
- d) Something that has a strong start but quickly fails = a flash in the pan

18. Get into hot water means

- a) To get into trouble
- b) A memorable day
- c) The best of a particular group
- d) Discuss best of a particular group

- a) To get into trouble=Get into hot water
- b) A memorable day = red letter day
- c) The best of a particular group = cream of the crop
- d) Discuss best of a particular group = beat about the bush

19. Be on cloud nine ' means

- a) By any possible means
- b) To be extremely happy and excited
- c) Die
- d) Major part

- a) By any possible means = by hook and by crook
- b) To be extremely happy and excited = be on cloud nine
- c) Die = kick the bucket
- d) Lion's share

20. Don't expect any help from this.....man

- a) Sweet-hearted
- b) Chicken -hearted
- c) Soft-hearted
- d) None of these

21) chicken hearted - means

- a) Honestly
- b) Friendly
- c) Fearfully
- d) merrily

22. I stood by him through thick and thin

- a) Under all conditions.
- b) At a very short distance
- c) Very rarely
- d) None of these

- a) Under all conditions = through thick and thin
- b) At a very short distance = a stone's throw
- c) Very rarely = once in a blue moon

23. Let the cat out of the bag

- a) Reveal secret carelessly or by mistake.
- b) In the fewest words possible
- c) Miserable life
- d) None of these

- a) Reveal secret carelessly or by mistake = let the cat out of the bag
- b) In the fewest words possible = in a nutshell
- c) Miserable life = dog's life

24. Wool gathering

- a) Daydreaming.
- b) Selfish motive
- c) In a similar situation
- d) None of these

- a) Daydreaming = wool gathering
- b) Selfish motive / to have dispute with someone = an axe to grind
- c) In a similar situation = in the same boat

25. From hand to mouth

- a) Sudden and totally unexpected
- b) A person with hidden abilities
- c) An object of ridicule
- d) To have just enough money to survive.

- a) Sudden and totally unexpected = a bolt from the blue
- b) A person with hidden abilities = a dark horse
- c) An object of ridicule = a laughing stock
- d) To have just enough money to survive = from hand to mouth

26. At the eleventh hour

- a) At the last possible moment.
- b) A short distance
- c) To keep away at a distance
- d) None of these

- a) At the last possible moment = at the eleventh hour
- b) A short distance = a stone's throw
- c) To keep away at a distance = at an arm's length

27. Bite your tongue means:

- a) To stay silent.
- b) A very difficult work
- c) To protect oneself
- d) To boast

- a) To stay silent = bite your tongue
- b) A very difficult work = a Herculean task
- c) To protect oneself = to save one's skin
- d) To boast = to blow one's own trumpet

28. The idiom 'break a leg' means:

- a) Good luck.
- b) Disreputable member of a group or a family
- c) By any possible means
- d) None of these

- a) Good luck = break a leg
- b) Disreputable member of a group or a family = black sheep
- c) By any possible means = by hook or by crook

29. The noise caused all the neighbours to

- a) Go nuts.
- b) An axe to grind
- c) Swan song
- d) None of these

- a) Go nuts = to become crazy / to become extremely angry
- b) An axe to grind = selfish motive / to have a dispute with someone
- c) Swan song = a person's last performance

30. The idiom 'bury the hatchet' means:

- a) Stop enmity.
- b) For and against
- c) To form imaginary plans
- d) Cruelly

- a) Stop enmity = bury the hatchet
- b) For and against = pros and cons
- c) To form imaginary plans = to build castles in the air
- d) Cruelly = in cold blood

31. A wild goose chase means:

- a) Perfect
- b) A short distance
- c) Foolish or hopeless search.
- d) To emphasise

- a) Perfect = apple pie order
- b) A short distance = a stone's throw
- c) Foolish or hopeless search = a wild goose chase
- d) To emphasise = to drive home

32. Hot under the collar means:

- a) Cruelly
- b) Died
- c) Angry.
- d) None of these

- a) Cruelly = in cold blood
- b) Died = kick the bucket
- c) Angry = hot under the collar

BIJEEESH10

33. A hard nut to crack means:

- a) Selfish motive
- b) A difficult problem to solve.
- c) To do something badly or cheaply to save money or time
- d) None of these

- a) Selfish motive = an axe to grind
- b) A difficult problem to solve = a hard nut to crack
- c) To do something badly or cheaply to save money or time = to cut corners

34. The idiom 'dog's life' means:

- a) A miserable life.
- b) To show sign of cowardice
- c) Easily frightened
- d) None of these

- a) A miserable life = dog's life
- b) To show sign of cowardice = to show the white feather
- c) Easily frightened = chicken-hearted

35. At your beck and call means:

- a) Sudden and totally unexpected
- b) Under someone's absolute control.
- c) To show sign of cowardice
- d) Easily frightened

- a) Sudden and totally unexpected = a bolt from the blue
- b) Under someone's absolute control = at your beck and call
- c) To show sign of cowardice = to show the white feather
- d) Easily frightened = chicken-hearted

36. A black sheep means:

- a) A disreputable member of a family or a group.
- b) A miserable life
- c) A difficult problem to solve
- d) None of these

- a) A disreputable member of a family or a group = a black sheep
- b) A miserable life = dog's life
- c) A difficult problem to solve = a hard nut to crack

37. To build castles in the air means:

- a) To form imaginary plans.
- b) Sudden and totally unexpected
- c) Under someone's absolute control
- d) None of these

- a) To form imaginary plans = to build castles in the air
- b) Sudden and totally unexpected = a bolt from the blue
- c) Under someone's absolute control = at your beck and call

36. A big bug means:

- a) A person of importance.
- b) Very successfully
- c) A disreputable member of a family or a group
- d) None of these

- a) A person of importance = a big bug
- b) Very successfully = with flying colours
- c) A disreputable member of a family or a group = a black sheep

37. To make both ends meet means:

- a) To form imaginary plans
- b) To earn just to survive.
- c) Very successfully
- d) Under someone's absolute control

- a) To form imaginary plans = to build castles in the air
- b) To earn just to survive = to make both ends meet
- c) Very successfully = with flying colours
- d) Under someone's absolute control = at your beck and call

39. Pros and cons means:

- a) A person of importance
- b) Favourable and unfavourable factors.
- c) A memorable day
- d) None of these

- a) A person of importance = a big bug
- b) Favourable and unfavourable factors = pros and cons
- c) A memorable day = a red letter day

40. Hot potato means:

- a) A controversial or sensitive issue.
- b) Very angry
- c) Major part
- d) None of these

- a) A controversial or sensitive issue = hot potato
- b) Very angry = hot under the collar
- c) Major part = lion's share

41. Through thick and thin means:

- a) Under all conditions.
- b) To be afraid
- c) Cruelly
- d) Angry

- a) Under all conditions = through thick and thin
- b) To be afraid = to get cold feet
- c) Cruelly = in cold blood
- d) Angry = hot under the collar

42. In high spirits means:

- a) Cruelly
- b) Angry
- c) Easily frightened
- d) Very happy.

- a) Cruelly = in cold blood
- b) Angry = hot under the collar
- c) Easily frightened = chicken-hearted
- d) Very happy = in high spirits

43. To get cold feet means:

- a) To be afraid.
- b) Angry
- c) Cruelly
- d) Under all conditions

- a) To be afraid = to get cold feet
- b) Angry = hot under the collar
- c) Cruelly = in cold blood
- d) Under all conditions = through thick and thin

44. White elephant means:

- a) Suspect that something is wrong
- b) Expensive but useless possession.
- c) A lazy person who usually spends time on watching television
- d) None of these

- a) Suspect that something is wrong = smell a rat
- b) Expensive but useless possession = white elephant
- c) A lazy person who usually spends time on watching television = couch potato

45. Head over heels means:

- a) Very excited.
- b) Easily frightened
- c) To get into trouble
- d) None of these

- a) Very excited = head over heels
- b) Easily frightened = chicken-hearted
- c) To get into trouble = get into hot water

46. Beat about the bush means:

- a) Discuss a matter without coming to the point.
- b) A difficult problem to solve
- c) To work hard without rest
- d) None of these

- a) Discuss a matter without coming to the point = beat about the bush
- b) A difficult problem to solve = a hard nut to crack
- c) To work hard without rest = burn the candle at the both ends

47. Dog in the manger means:

- a) Miserable life
- b) Rain very heavily
- c) Expensive but useless possession
- d) A person who selfishly keeps something that she or he does not really need so that others may not use or enjoy it.

- a) Miserable life = dog's life
- b) Rain very heavily = rain cats and dogs
- c) Expensive but useless possession = white elephant
- d) A person who selfishly keeps something that she or he does not really need so that others may not use or enjoy it = dog in the manger

48. The alpha and omega means:

- a) Very difficult work
- b) Beginning and end.
- c) To protect oneself
- d) A hidden enemy

- a) Very difficult work = A Herculean Task
- b) Beginning and end = alpha and omega
- c) To protect oneself = to save one's skin
- d) A hidden enemy = a snake in the grass

49. To let the grass grow under one's feet means:

- a) To boast
- b) To remain idle.
- c) A hidden enemy
- d) A source of advancement

- a) To boast = to blow one's own trumpet
- b) To remain idle = To let the grass grow under one's feet
- c) A hidden enemy = a snake in the grass
- d) A source of advancement = a stepping stone

50. Wolf in the sheep's clothing means:

- a) Hypocrite.
- b) Irritate
- c) To emphasise
- d) Cruelly

- a) Hypocrite = Wolf in the sheep's clothing
- b) Irritate = to set one's teeth on edge
- c) To emphasise = to drive home
- d) Cruelly = in cold blood

THANK YOU

BIJEEESH10